

GIS Layers · Reading Place

I can select and combine GIS layers at two scales to produce and qualify an evidence-based place description.

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

Arrival · retrieve and reconnect

Standard

Confirm the W8 report-back status, retrieve the map judgement and add one evidence limit.

Starter · enquiry / tension

Enquiry

What can GIS reveal about a place—and what does it hide?

QUESTION / HYPOTHESIS

Start with a question you can test: where do people live, and why there?

MAP / DATA / METHOD

Layers are evidence. Housing clusters near transport — a pattern .

PATTERN + ANOMALY

Starter · enquiry / tension

Anomaly: some housing sits inside the flood zone. The pattern is not the whole story.

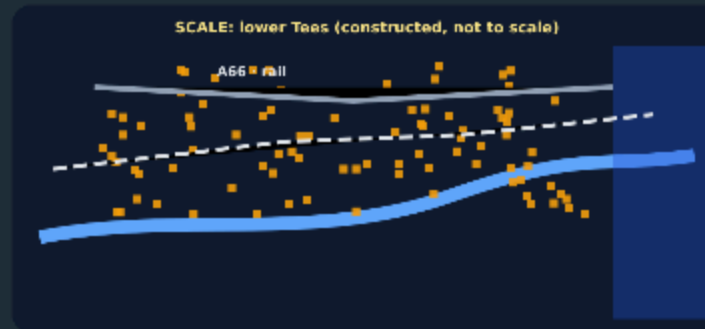
JUDGEMENT + LIMIT

A judgement with a limit: the layers show where , not why or who . Change scale and the picture changes.

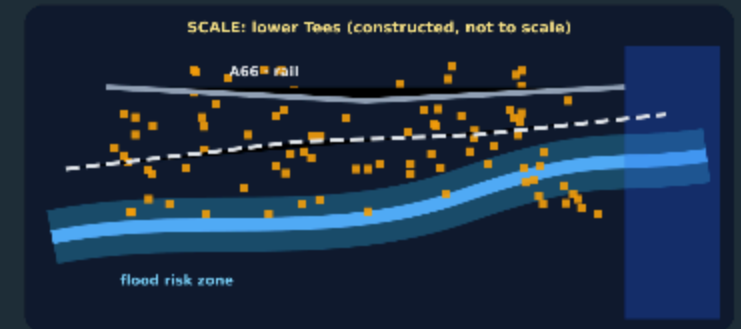
Starter · enquiry / tension



Base layer: river and sea only

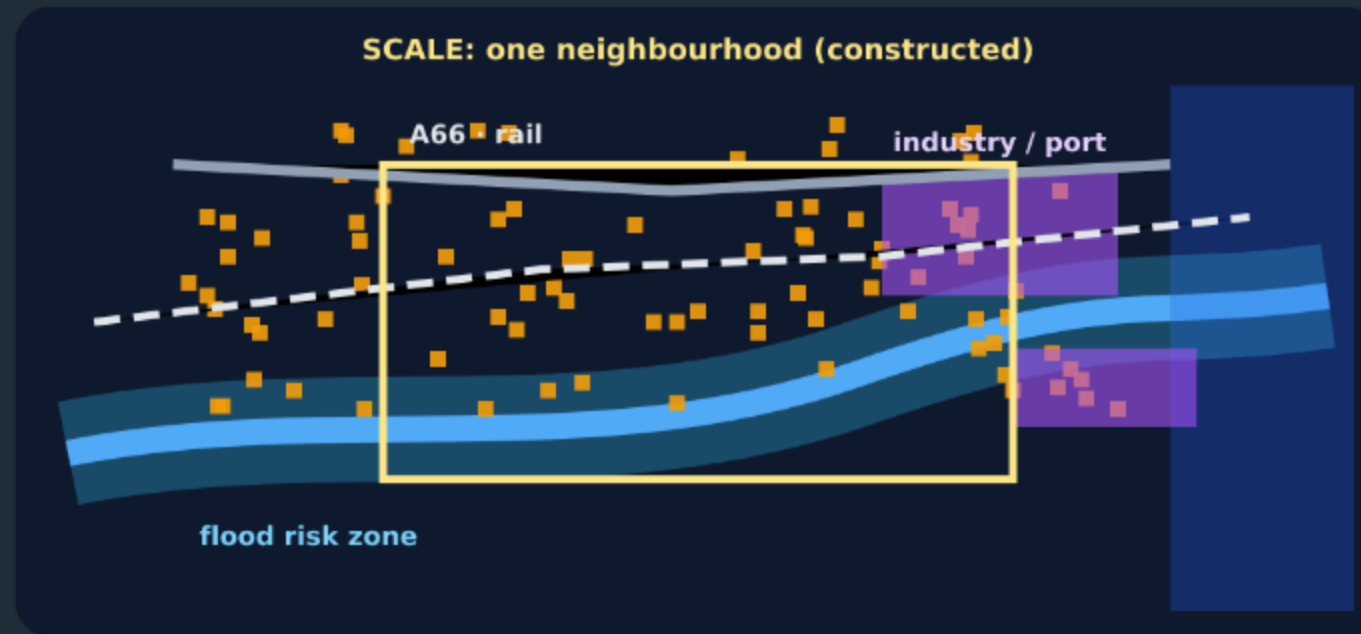


Housing and transport layers added



Flood-risk layer added

Starter · enquiry / tension



All layers with a zoom box

I Do · model geographical reasoning

Model one reasoning step at a time.

Read title, key, date, scale and source before describing any pattern.

Locate precisely, then describe distribution as clustered, linear, dispersed or concentrated.

Combine two layers to suggest a possible relationship; keep explanation separate from description.

GIS layer stack · switch layers on and off

I Do · model geographical reasoning

Constructed model: a schematic, not real GIS data. It rehearses selecting and combining layers at two scales.

- A. river + sea
- B. housing
- C. roads + rail
- D. industry / port
- E. flood risk
- F. zoom to one neighbourhood

I Do · model geographical reasoning

Base layer only. Add housing and roads. What pattern appears?

A. Claim A: people live near transport because it is convenient

B. Claim B: the housing layer shows a cluster near transport; the reason needs other evidence

Which claim does the layer stack actually support?

I Do · model geographical reasoning

Layered schematic GIS map

We Do · hinge judgement

Commit before reveal: Which sentence best describes the situation of a place?

A. The site occupies mostly flat land.

B. It lies east of the centre and is linked to it by a bridge and rail corridor.

C. Retail is the dominant land use.

I Do 2 · counter / qualification

Strengthen—not lengthen—the reasoning.

Use Locate → Layer → Link → Limit to control the description.

A mapped relationship is a hypothesis, not proof of cause.

State which missing layer, date or scale would most improve the judgement.

We Do 2 · interactive reasoning lab

Layer Lens · Teesbridge Quarter

CONSTRUCTED CLASSROOM RESOURCE: This fictional composite is inspired by the broad Teesside setting. It is not official data, is not to scale and must not be used for navigation, safety or real-world planning.

≈ river = transport  land use ● services environment

Select more than one thematic layer to combine evidence. Base resets the view.

We Do 2 · interactive reasoning lab

- A. Base / reset
- B. Transport
- C. Land use
- D. Services
- E. Environment

Base layer ready. Combine two layers, describe a pattern, then name a limit.

Independent · sustained evidence

Independent mission

I can select and combine GIS layers at two scales to produce and qualify an evidence-based place description.

16 minutes. Approved access can change format, reading load or response mode; it cannot supply the geographical judgement.

Supported

Sort six prepared statements into site or situation, complete a four-sentence description using two layers, then add one sentence from the wider corridor view.

Independent · sustained evidence

Supported access: layer key, site/situation sorter and Locate → Layer → Link → Limit headings.

Standard

Write a place evidence brief with location, two patterns, a layer relationship, one limitation and one claim that survives, changes or becomes less certain at the wider scale.

Standard scaffold: claim → mapped detail → comparison → limitation.

Stretch

Independent · sustained evidence

Judge which two layers are most useful for locating a fictional clinic; reject one layer and explain uncertainty.

Stretch scaffold: weigh layer usefulness across two scales and reject a plausible alternative.

Exit · evidence → response → Influence

VOICE: Name the strongest layer for the enquiry, one pattern it reveals and one thing it cannot prove.